Linagliptin

Helps lower your blood sugar

What does it do?

- Helps your body use insulin better and reduces the extra sugar made by your liver.
- Lowers blood sugar levels.
- Does not usually cause weight gain.



How should I take it?

- Take it once daily, at the same time each day.
- Swallow the tablet whole with water.
- Can be taken with or without food.
- Do not crush, chew or break the tablet.



Common side effects

- Nausea
- Vomiting
- Diarrhoea
- Constipation
- Abdominal pain
- Headache
- Dizziness
- Upper respiratory tract infection
- Joint pain

These side effects are usually mild and temporary.



Symptoms of low blood sugar (hypoglycaemia)

You may feel:

- Shakiness
- Sweating
- Dizziness
- Hunger
- Weakness
- Confusion
- Irritability
- Difficulty in concentrating

Linagliptin alone rarely causes low blood sugar, but the risk increases when combined with insulin or sulfonylureas.



15-15 Rule for Low Blood Sugar



1. **Take 15 grams of fast-acting sugar** (e.g., 3–4 glucose tablets, ½ cup fruit juice, or 1 tablespoon sugar/honey).

→



2. **Wait 15 minutes** and check your blood sugar again (if possible).

→



3. **If still low,** repeat the 15 grams of sugar and wait another 15 minutes.

Once above 70 mg/dL, have a small snack or meal if appropriate.

Seek medical attention immediately if you develop:

- Severe or persistent low blood sugar (not relieved by 15-15 rule).
- Repeated vomiting, unable to keep food or water down.
- Severe diarrhoea or dehydration.
- Signs of allergic reaction (rash, swelling of face, lips, tongue or throat, difficulty breathing).
- Symptoms of pancreatitis (severe stomach pain, nausea, vomiting) – rare.
- Yellowing of skin or eyes (liver problems) – rare.



Do not stop linagliptin without consulting your doctor or pharmacist.